

B&H Sell Used — Quote Status Email Redesign

Stakeholder Working Session · July 13, 2026 · Meeting Notes & Next Steps

Executive Summary

This working session focused on redesigning the **Quote Status Update email** sent to sellers when their used gear submission has an issue requiring follow-up. The meeting brought together the Used Department (Fred, Isaac), Product (Jerel), and UX (John) to capture stakeholder requirements and facilitate a clean handoff to UX design. The outcome is a tightly scoped deliverable: **copy-only refresh of the existing email template**, with a target of BHUX-34723.

Meeting Date	July 13, 2026
Meeting Type	Stakeholder Requirements / UX Handoff
Attendees	Jerel Smith (PM), Isaac (Director of Used), Fred (Used Eval Lead), John (UX Designer)
Primary Output	BHUX-34723 — Quote Status Email Copy Refresh
Scope Decision	Copy-only update now; full template redesign deferred to post-Sell Used flow completion
Target Date	July 17, 2026 (Monday)

Background & Context

The Quote Status Email — What It Is

When a seller submits used gear for a quote (online instant or quote-by-email) and a discrepancy or issue is identified after the item is received, B&H; sends an automated status update email asking the customer to call the Used Department to resolve the issue. This email is the primary communication bridge between the evaluation team and the seller when a quote cannot be processed as-is.

Reasons an Email Is Triggered

- **Condition discrepancy:** Item evaluated at a lower condition tier than quoted (e.g., listed as 9+ but received as 7)
- **Missing accessories:** Required accessories were not included with the shipment (most common reason)
- **Wrong item received:** Seller sent a different model or version than quoted
- **Non-purchasable item:** Item is broken, too damaged, or otherwise cannot be bought in its current state
- **Missing box count:** Multi-box shipment received fewer boxes than expected; waiting on remainder
- **Address / payment issue:** Check address not filled out correctly, or payment method clarification needed
- **Unknown payment preference:** Customer did not indicate check vs. store credit preference

Volume	Approximately 10–15% of incoming quotes require this email. The team has recently expanded its use — previously only certain evaluators triggered it; now all evaluators send it as standard practice, increasing volume noticeably over the past two months.
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Current Email — Known Shortcomings

The existing email has several issues that reduce its effectiveness:

- Subject line reads generically (e.g., "NHS Department Status Update") — lacks urgency and clarity
- Body copy is vague: does not indicate the nature of the issue or what specifically the customer needs to do
- No mention of operating hours — customers don't know when to call
- No strong call-to-action driving customers toward a phone call
- Template uses a plural "'s" on item references that makes the automated origin obvious
- No follow-up cadence communicated — customers are unaware that items may be returned if unresolved

Current Resolution Process

Once a customer calls in, the Used Department buying team reviews the quote in UNIX (internal system) and resolves the issue via one of the following outcomes:

- Negotiate an adjusted price (up or down depending on actual condition)
- Accept the item as-is at the revised quote
- Return the item to the seller (free return label provided)
- Update the quote to reflect correct accessories or item version

Key Rule	No payment is issued and no item is returned until the team speaks with the customer. Items remain on hold. The quote remains pending until contact is made.
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Follow-Up & Unclaimed Item Policy

There is currently no regulated follow-up cadence. In practice, follow-ups occur every 5–6 days by phone or email. Unclaimed items sitting on the shelf are flagged in a dashboard and the team attempts to close them out. **There is no formal policy on what happens after 30 days** — this was identified as a gap. Isaac mentioned a possible 30-day responsibility cutoff, though this has not been formally established or communicated to customers.

Quote Flow: Instant Quote vs. Quote by Email

Two paths exist for sellers submitting a quote. Both eventually result in the same customer-facing email if an issue is detected:

How it starts	Seller creates quote on B&H; online portal; all items have instant pricing	Item is old, rare, or custom — no instant price available
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Quote delivery	Seller receives full line-item breakdown with prices within ~5 mins	Seller receives a "please call us" email; price is provided after internal review
Shipping label	Prepaid FedEx label included with quote confirmation	Prepaid FedEx label also provided
If issue found	Status update email triggered; quote placed on hold	Same status update email triggered
Scope of this ticket	Yes — in scope	Yes — same template applies across both

Shipping Label Edge Cases

- B&H; provides a prepaid FedEx label for domestic (lower 48 states) shipments; international sellers or Alaska/Hawaii use their own label
- When sellers use their own label, they are asked to provide a tracking number
- Some customers use personal shipping for preference, comfort, or insurance reasons even when a B&H; label is available
- A small percentage of sellers are unaware a prepaid label is included and ship on their own

Scope Decision & Design Direction

What Is In Scope (BHUX-34723)

SCOPE	Copy-only refresh of the current quote status email. Subject line, email body, and local field (from/reply-to address). No new logic, no new template design, no dynamic issue flagging.
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- Rewrite subject line to convey urgency clearly (replace generic "status update" phrasing)
- Rewrite body copy to be more direct, professionally urgent, and action-oriented (primary CTA: call us)
- Include Used Department operating hours in the email body
- Reference the quote number in the header (already done; maintain this)
- Personalize with customer name (confirm whether currently implemented)
- Ensure reply-to address resolves to used@bhphoto.com (currently confirmed)
- Scope size: Extra Small (XS) — copy refresh, no new design
- Applies to both revised quotes (instant) and quote-by-email paths

What Is Out of Scope (Deferred)

- **Dynamic issue categorization** — building a flag/checklist in UNIX for evaluators to select a reason category that populates the email is a separate, larger initiative requiring UNIX workflow changes
- **Template visual redesign** — deferred until full Sell Used flow email template suite is completed (new template includes visual status tracker); this email will be updated to new template at that time to maintain consistency
- **Automated acceptance flow** — ability for customer to accept a revised quote via email (no action required now)

- **Formal unclaimed item policy** — 30-day policy and automated follow-up cadence is a separate operational decision
- **Reply-to tracking** — understanding volume of customers responding by email vs. calling (noted as a useful future metric)

Key Design Decisions Confirmed

- **Primary CTA:** Phone call. Do NOT mention email reply as a CTA. If customers reply by email, the team will handle it, but the email should not encourage it.
- **Reply-to address:** used@bhphoto.com — confirmed active and monitored. Replies are received but not the primary resolution channel.
- **Issue specificity:** Keep generic for now. Acknowledge there is an issue; do not attempt to enumerate the reason in this version.
- **Hours to display:** Reference Sell Used / Sales department hours (confirm with John for exact current hours — appears to be Mon–Thu 9–7, Fri 9–2 with seasonal variation). Clarify if Customer Service hours differ.
- **Item reference:** Reference the quote, not the individual product, since quotes often include many items.
- **Tone:** Professional urgency. Not accusatory or blaming. Clear that quote is on hold until customer contacts us.
- **Template:** Use existing email template for now. New visual template applied post-Sell Used flow completion.

Open Questions & Gaps

- **Hours accuracy:** Exact Sell Used department operating hours need to be confirmed (John to verify). Seasonal variation exists. Confirm if Customer Service hours differ.
- **Unclaimed item policy:** No formal 30-day policy exists. Isaac floated 30 days but it was not decided. This needs to be established before it can be communicated to sellers.
- **Customer address field:** Current email may include customer shipping address. Confirm whether this should be retained in new copy.
- **Email reply volume:** Unknown how many customers reply to the email vs. call in. Isaac to explore logging/tracking this.
- **Escalation follow-up cadence:** No regulated cadence for follow-up emails or calls. If formalizing, this would be a separate initiative (not this ticket).
- **Personalization field:** Confirm customer name is populated in current email implementation. Isaac indicated it may be; confirm with UNIX team.
- **Multi-box / multi-item language:** Email template is generic. For multi-box scenarios, customers receive the same generic email — no specific reference to which box is missing. Confirm this remains acceptable.

Action Items & Next Steps

Action Item	Owner	Priority	Notes
Draft revised subject line and email body copy	John (UX)	P1 — Urgent	Target: July 17. Copy-only. Use existing template. Reference quote number, hours, CTA to call.

Action Item	Owner	Priority	Notes
Confirm Sell Used department operating hours	John / Isaac	P1 — Blocker	Exact hours needed before copy is finalized. Confirm Mon–Thu and Fri hours + seasonal variation.
Confirm whether Customer Service and Sales hours differ	Isaac / Fred	P1	If different, determine which to reference in email. Historically they differed.
Create BHUX-34723 ticket and add to John's queue	Jerel	P1 — Done	Ticket created. Verify it appears in John's queue. Size: XS.
Set up BHUX-specific chat group	Jerel	P2	Add Fred, Isaac, and core UX/PM team members for async Q&A; on this ticket.
Share current email screenshot / design file with John	Isaac / Jerel	P2	Current email referenced as already in Figma. Confirm John has access.
Confirm reply-to address routing	Isaac	P2	used@bhphoto.com confirmed. Validate replies are being monitored by someone on the team.
Log / quantify email reply volume (future)	Isaac / Fred	P3 — Deferred	Understand what % of customers respond via email vs. phone. Informs future iteration.
Establish 30-day unclaimed item policy (future)	Isaac / Operations	P3 — Deferred	Not a blocker for this ticket but identified as an operational gap to address.
Align dynamic issue flagging in UNIX (future)	Jerel / Isaac / UNIX	P3 — Deferred	Bigger initiative: allow evaluators to flag reason category that populates email. Requires UNIX workflow changes.
Update email template to match new Sell Used visual suite	John / UNIX Eng	P3 — Deferred	Once full Sell Used flow email templates are complete, apply new visual template consistently across all emails including this one.

Relationship to Broader Sell Used Initiative

This email is directly related to, but scoped separately from, the broader **Sell Used flow redesign (BHP-6434 / BHUX-33009)**. Key relationships to track:

- **Post-submission status tracking:** The Sell Used redesign includes post-quote status visibility in My Account (Brendan Bagley to coordinate). This email is the off-platform version of that same status signal.
- **Visual email template:** New Sell Used flow will introduce a unified email template with visual status trackers. This email will be migrated to that template once available — not now.
- **Quote-by-email path:** Same email applies to quote-by-email submissions. Ensure the copy is not written to assume a specific path.
- **Trade-In:** Trade-in quote email refresh (design and copy only, no new functionality) is a related but separate ticket targeted for a later sprint. Similar principles apply.

Deferred / Out-of-Scope Topics (Noted for Backlog)

- Automated time-based follow-up sequence (e.g., Day 2, Day 5, Day 10 emails)
- Dynamic reason flagging in UNIX (evaluator picks from issue category; email auto-populates reason)
- Customer self-service to accept revised quote via email or portal
- Seller-facing My Account status visibility for quote-on-hold scenarios
- Formal policy and customer-facing communication for unclaimed items after X days
- Multilingual customer support (Spanish-speaking customer mentioned as real case — flagged as edge case)
- Tracking number capture for sellers who ship on their own label

*Notes prepared by Jerel Smith, Senior PM, B&H; Used Web. Distribution: Isaac Mittelman, John Keeler, Fred. July 13, 2026.
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